The Noble Unconquerable One Called Giver of Fearlessness

Āryābhayapradā nāma Aparājitā · Toh 928 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་མི་འཇིགས་པ་སྦྱིན་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བཀའ་གཞུང་མཛད་པ།

The Noble Unconquerable One Called Giver of Fearlessness, known in Sanskrit as Āryābhayapradā nāma Aparājitā, is a short dhāraṇī text centered on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the great being endowed with great compassion. It opens with homages to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, to the Three Jewels, and to Avalokiteśvara as the one who dispels the suffering of beings, cuts their bonds, and grants them fearlessness. It then presents his unconquerable essence mantra, which is said to accomplish every rite and to protect against harmful spirits such as bhūtas. This work is Toh 928 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇīs, the protective and ritual incantations gathered among the tantric texts of the canon.

In the language of India: ārya abhaya pradā nāma aparājita

In the language of Tibet: The Noble Unconquerable One Called Giver of Fearlessness.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas! Homage to all the accomplished ones! Homage to the Buddha! Homage to the Dharma! Homage to the Saṅgha! Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the one endowed with great compassion, the noble Avalokiteśvara! Homage to the one who dispels the suffering of all sentient beings! Homage to the one who frees all sentient beings from suffering! Homage to the one who cuts the bonds of all sentient beings! Homage to the one who gives fearlessness to all sentient beings!

Now I shall recite the unconquerable essence of the fearless noble Avalokiteśvara.

It accomplishes every rite and is virtuous;
No bhūta can bring any fear.
From nectar, nectar comes forth;
This is what accomplishes every rite.
It strikes terror into every enemy.
Quarrels and likewise fights,
Being surrounded by others and by enemies,
Opponents in the midst of disputes,

And constant encounters with enemies,
It stupefies them and paralyzes them;
It bewilders them, and it dispels evil.
It makes poison and fire subside,
And it dispels epidemics and every wrongdoing.
Bandits and thieves, water and snakes,
And every bad dream it dispels;
It turns back all bhūtas.
It leads to the awakening of a buddha
And fully reveals all phenomena.
This is a vidyā-mantra of mighty power;
Unconquerable, it crushes the rākṣasas.
When this vidyā-mantra was spoken,
Then this world began to shake.
The unsurpassed king of vidyā-mantras
Called Endowed with Fearlessness
Was spoken by the Protector of the World,
And all three worlds pay it homage.

Then the fearless Avalokiteśvara called the Tathāgata to mind and spoke this, his own unconquerable essence, spoken by all the tathāgatas:

oṃ tara tara tāre tāre morike candraprabhe bhiri bhiri ciri ciri sūryakānte hemaprabhe buddhya buddhya bodhani sarvapāpapraśamani cara cara viṣapraśamani ciri ciri curu curu sarvavidyādharanamaskrite dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru sarvatathāgatabhāṣita para para piri piri puru puru prajñāpāramitā anujñāte ṣaṭapāramita paripūre gaṃgānadībālukopama tathāgata bhāṣita priyaṃkari dhanakari pritikari śubhakari pavitra maṃgaladhāriṇi sarvadevatā adhiṣṭhite sarvamahoraga adhiṣṭhite sarvakiṃnara adhiṣṭhite sarvayakṣarākṣasa adhiṣṭhite prahmabhāṣite indrabhāṣite caturamahārājabhāṣite candrasūryabhāṣite oṃ tiri tiri candrakīraṇe kili kili sarvaśatrūṃ vināśani hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, endowed with loving-kindness, said this to the bodhisattva Abhayaprada:

"Abhayaprada, long ago, in times past, beyond as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, there appeared in the world a tathāgata, an arhat, a perfectly complete buddha, endowed with knowledge

and conduct, who benefits all sentient beings, called Radiance of the Unconquerable Lord. From him I heard these teachings. From that time on I have taught them to the bodhisattvas and to all sentient beings as well.

"This unconquerable essence that gives fearlessness was spoken by the seven perfectly complete buddhas: Vipaśyin, Śikhin, Viśvabhū, Krakucchanda, Kanakamuni, Kāśyapa, and Śākyamuni.

"This unconquerable essence protects oneself, protects others, and protects both. It protects villages, cities, market towns, regions, countries, and royal palaces. It guards life, grants long life, and paralyzes weapons. It pacifies all quarrels, fights, battles, and disputes. It turns back all enemies, frees from all bonds, and is unconquerable everywhere."

śuddhe mukte prabhāsvare śvete paṇḍarāhāsini sarvaduṣṭana jaṃbhayāmi stambhayāmi mohayāmi oṃ svāhā pavitre svāhā śvete svāhā śvetepatapavittre svāhā tadyathā tāre tāre tāriṇi rakṣa rakṣa sarvakali kalaha vigraha vivyādhi duḥsopnabhayebhyaḥ svāhā

Whoever, always free of laziness,
Upholds this dhāraṇī,
Is protected at all times
By all the hosts of gods as well.
That person will know no fear;
Always protected, he abides in radiance,
Just as the sun above the earth
Shines, bearing splendor and renown.
Executioners, sorcery,
And pūtanas cannot harm him;
Glory and merit will come to him,
And his complexion and his life increase.

This completes The Noble Unconquerable One Called Giver of Fearlessness.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the chief editor and translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, among others.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the past tathāgata is translated from the Tibetan as "Radiance of the Unconquerable Lord," because no Sanskrit form could be confirmed. In the line "This unconquerable essence that gives fearlessness," the words "giver of fearlessness" could also be read as a second address to the bodhisattva Abhayaprada. Here they are taken as

describing the essence, in keeping with the title.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.